

PAMSA - Mid-Term

1. The poet Mushafi (c. 1750–1824) declared around 1785 that the mode of the day was:
a) Persian verse b) Arabic prose c) **Hindvi verse** d) Sanskrit epic
2. The term “Urdu” as a name for the language first appears in the works of:
a) Amir Khusrau b) Mir Amman c) **Mushafi** d) Shah Alam II
3. Initially, the term *zabān-e urdu-e mu‘alla* signified which language? **Persian**
4. Which Mughal emperor’s informal use and patronage of Hindi gave the language new respectability in Delhi?
a) Akbar b) Shah Jahan c) Aurangzeb d) **Shah Alam II**
5. John Gilchrist argued that “Hinduwee” was:
a) **Exclusive property of Hindus** b) A language created by Muslim invaders c) A superior form of Hindustani d) Best written in Roman script
6. The story that Urdu was born in Muslim army camps was popularized by:
a) Khān-e Ārzū b) **Mir Amman’s *Bāgh-o-Bahār*** c) Ghalib d) British military manuals
7. Aḥad ‘Alī Khān Yaktā attributed the development of Urdu to:
a) Military lingua franca b) **Mixing of languages through interaction of different communities of common people and at royal court** c) A decree from Akbar d) Influence of Sufi saints
8. Bharatendu Harishchandra began his literary career in:
a) Sanskrit b) Braj Bhasha c) **Urdu** d) Bengali
9. Muhammad Husain Āzād’s *Āb-e Ḥayāt* is criticized for:
a) Being too long b) **Ignoring major Hindu poets** c) Promoting Nagari script d) Focusing only on secular poetry
10. Gilchrist claimed that in Persian, the word hindi means **Negro**, which Faruqi calls a canard.
11. The word for ethnicity in Urdu is **none**.
12. There is no ‘ethnically’ **homogeneous** territorial space on Earth.
13. The ‘founding father’ of modern scientific nomenclature was **Carl Linnæus**

14. Gujarat's famous Somnath temple was fortified by locals to protect it from Mahmud of Ghazni.
a) True b) **False**

15. Two of the names of God used by Shah Fazl-e-Rahman Ganj Muradabadi:
a) **_Manmohan_** b) **_Palanhaar_**

16. The three elements of the Orientalist "triptych" were:
a) _____ b) _____ c) _____.

17. Misperceptions about India's past:
– Classical texts represent _____.
– India was timeless meaning _____.

18. The first Turkic dynasty was established by _____ in 1206.

19. Aurangzeb fought with _____ and _____.

20. Akbar invited to Fatehpur Sikri _____, Jains, Jesuits, Zoroastrians, and Muslim scholars.

21. Hastings founded the College of Fort William at _____ in 1802 to train _____.

22. The Asiatic Society of Bengal was founded under Sir _____ to _____.

23. The system of indirect rule created by the EIC was _____.

24. The period of Delhi Sultanate was characterized by: (select all that apply)

- a. extension of commercial networks**
- b. expansion of the agricultural frontier**
- c. gradual technological change**
- d. mass conversions to Islam
- e. development of political and religious institutions**
- f. creative cultural expression in local, vernacular contexts**

25. There is marked discontinuity between the Delhi Sultanate and earlier Indian regimes.
a) True b) **False**

26. The first Turkic dynasty in Delhi was established by the Mamluk or slave ruler _____ in 1206.
a) **Qutb-ud-Din Aibak** b) Iltutmish c) Balban d) Ala-ud-Din Khilji
27. Non-Muslims were governed by *sharia* under the Delhi Sultanate.
a) True b) **False**
28. India's Muslim populations are primarily found in the core areas of Muslim rule.
a) True b) **False**
29. The passage beginning "He who is immersed in His love..." is by:
a) Kabir b) **Nanak** c) Chaitanya d) Mirabai
30. The unifying ideology for the Mughal Empire was:
a) Loyalty to Hindustan b) **Loyalty to the emperor** c) Loyalty to the court language d) Loyalty to the religion of the emperor
31. Analyzing the decline following Aurangzeb's rule, Metcalf and Metcalf hold that a singular focus on the personality and policies of one ruler is not only inadequate but also fits easily into the old European theory of
a) Asiatic Glory b) **Asiatic Despotism** c) Orientalism d) Enlightenment
32. The Naqshbandi Sufi Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi criticized _____ policies of Akbar and was imprisoned by emperor **Jahangir**
a) **Cultural** b) Economic c) Political d) Administrative
33. In 1739, the armies of the Persian king **Nadir Shah** looted the city of **Delhi**, killing some **30,000** people and taking Shah Jahan's **peacock throne**.
34. The great _____ Survey began in 1818
a) Geometrical b) Numerical c) **Trigonometrical** d) Geographical
35. The Marathas were finally defeated by the British in:
a) 1815 b) **1818** c) 1820 d) 1822
36. The Bengal famine occurred in:
a) **1770** b) 1777 c) 1787 d) 1775
37. Ram Mohan Roy established the _____ in 1828.
a) Arya Samaj b) Sanatan Dharma c) **Brahmo Samaj** d) Brahmo Dharam
38. The practice banned by Lord Bentinck was:
a) **Sati** b) Dowry c) Caste discrimination d) Untouchability

39. The author of *Minutes on Education* (1835) was:
a) Lord Minto **b) Lord Macaulay** c) Lord Bentinck d) Lord Cornwallis
40. The above stated _____
41. During the late 18th century, British officials lived with Indian mistresses called **Bibis**, which ended after the introduction of the **Cornwallis code**.
42. The term mononomological refers to a **language having only one name**.
43. According to Richard Eaton, what was one advantage of temple construction by kings?
a) Political legitimacy and public display of power
b) Economic loss to the state
c) Religious intolerance
d) Reduced political stability
44. According to Richard Eaton, what was one disadvantage of temple construction by kings?
a) It promoted equality
b) Temples could be destroyed in invasions, symbolizing political defeat
c) It weakened religious institutions
d) It decreased royal popularity
45. Name three major Sufi orders in South Asia:
46. Barbara Metcalf prefers calling the Mughal rule the “early modern period” rather than “medieval” because:
It shows cosmopolitanism, and global linkages
47. Which of the following is not a reason the Mughal period cannot be termed “foreign”?
a) Mughals were born in India
b) They married into Indian families
c) They brought Persian culture without local adaptation
d) They ruled through Indian institutions
48. The statement “Dara Shikoh was liberal and Aurangzeb conservative” is oversimplified because:
a) Both were influenced by politics, not just religion
49. The term *Shahinshah* signifies that Mughal rulers:
One king among many, meaning that there were smaller kingdoms and states or parallel authorities existing under the larger umbrella of Mughal empire, on which it depended for its power.
50. Bhimsen Saxena was:
a) A Mughal chronicler who wrote about Aurangzeb’s administration
b) A Maratha general
c) A British historian

d) A poet in Akbar's court

51. Name the three fault lines in Mughal rule.

52. Which reason best supports that Shivaji's struggle was political, not religious?

- a) **He employed Muslims in his army and administration**
- b) He destroyed all Mughal temples
- c) He converted to Islam
- d) He banned trade with Persia

53. Warren Hastings believed that India's laws should:

- a) **Be derived and codified from local traditions and scriptures**
- b) Replace British common law
- c) Be uniform across religions
- d) Abolish personal law systems

54. The phenomenon of Military Fiscalism refers to: (one line)

55. Under Company Raj, which trade played a major role in the colonial economy?

- a) **Opium trade with China**
- b) Gold trade with Persia
- c) Silk trade with Europe
- d) Cotton trade with Africa

56. The British classified tribes like the Banjaras as "criminal tribes" because:

- a) **They did not settle permanently and defied colonial order**
- b) They engaged in agriculture
- c) They paid high taxes
- d) They joined the Mughal army

57. The introduction of property rights in Bengal under British rule led to:

- a) **The rise of zamindars and peasant indebtedness**
- b) Collective land ownership
- c) Improved farmer welfare
- d) Abolition of private property